

sock away in your twenties, the more you'll have in your twilight years. To build that fortune, you have to lose the debt as soon as possible. So get your head around a fifty- to sixty-hour workweek—not forever, just for now. That is the only way you're going to get debt-free. I can't stress this enough.

We've learned that money equals time, so the more time you spend away from the clubs or the Internet or TV, and the more time you can spend working, the more money you're going to have. Another reason for working like a dog when you're young is that you're not going to be able to when you're old. And if you do it this way, you're not going to have to.

"But Uncle Kevin, what about balance? What about quality of life? Hobbies? Lounging around? Must everything always be about money?" Yes. Debt repayment is a critical skill. And if you master it when you're young, you're less likely to get into bigger, more problematic debts down the line. Here's the golden rule: *As long as you're paying a student loan, you're to continue to live like a student.* It's that simple. As long as there is debt associated with a previous lifestyle, you should be living according to that previous lifestyle. And here's another trick. As soon as that debt is paid, continue to live according to that previous lifestyle in order to get ahead. Up the amount you funnel into your Secret 10, to get even richer, but don't alter your lifestyle.

I'm going to let you in on a little secret. I have a home in Boston. It's an apartment in a historic brownstone, about one thousand square feet. I've owned and sold companies worth billions in the years since my wife and I first bought that place. My income has doubled, maybe even tripled since then. And guess what? I still own that little place. You might think it's nothing special, but my wife and I love it. It's the perfect size for us, and its layout is ideal for entertaining. It's "enough." As my income grew, our appetite for more stuff was relegated to a few big purchases, a summer home being one of them. And yes, I, too, bought a midlife-crisis car, and yes, even after I drove home and my wife said, "Oh, look, another bald asshole in a Porsche," I was still thrilled with the purchase. Because I put it in context: That